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Session 041 Review

Match clip analysis - in possession, final third, transitions, build-up, and defensive phase.

In Possession - Build-Up & Combination Play

Areas for Improvement

- Play 1** Improve body shape and open up the first touch (avoid receiving with the body turned inward).
- Play 2** Closed first touch limits combination play with the right back.
- Play 3** Over-disguised intention when trying to find free players - made the play harder to read.
- Play 4** Again: first touch goes inside instead of opening up the field.
- Play 5** Identify the space behind the press and, at times, switch play to the other side.
- Play 6** Teammate under double pressure; even with the right back in space, disguised the pass instead of using that option.
- Play 7** Attempted a long ball - another example where it was better to look to the other side first.
- Play 8** The goalkeeper did not help on the build-up; poor body shape again, with the first touch turned inside.

Good Plays

- Play 9** Good example of faking the long ball and finding a better passing option.
- Play 10** Disguising the pass and deceiving the opposite winger, who jumped to intercept.
- Play 11** Good open first touch, allowing the pass to the right back.
- Play 12** Good movement and pass between the lines.

Key themes

- First touch and body shape (open vs. closed).
- Reading pressure; switching play to the weak side.
- Disguise to beat defenders vs. over-disguising when options are clear.
- Right-back involvement; goalkeeper support on build-up.

Final Third

- Play 1** Execution: poor first-time cross.
- Play 2** Left-foot control, good 1v1; poor finishing execution.
- Play 3** Left-foot control, still gets out of trouble. Poor finish. Far side had stronger options.
- Play 4** Space to drive; teammate in a potential overload. Right-foot control sets up a good 1v1.
- Play 5** Ball too far from the body; LB ball-watching - good chance to penetrate in behind.
- Play 6** Again too far from the LB - no penetration option.
- Play 7** Poor control, but escapes the press. Could have carried further; the pass wasn't necessarily wrong.
- Play 8** Inside channel - keep the ball closer on the dribble.

Key themes

- Finishing and crossing execution.
- Ball distance from feet; penetration when LB ball-watches.
- Far-side options; carry vs. pass; tighter control in inside channels.

Attacking Transition

- Play 1** Opportunity to run in behind the LB.
- Play 2** Why not go wide? Possible numerical advantage on that side.
- Play 3** Left-foot control.
- Play 4** Could carry longer, commit the defender, and delay to allow a teammate's run in behind.
- Play 5** Good tackle; ball carried too far from the foot invites dispossession.
- Play 6 & 7** More examples of teammates driving with the ball away from the foot and being dispossessed.

Key themes

- Runs in behind the full-back; wide play and numerical advantage.
- Carry, disguise, and delay for third-man runs.
- Loose touches leading to turnovers.

Build-Up

Second-phase build-up - progressing into the final third.

- Play 1** Spot the teammate already in space; LB ball-watching - penetration opportunity.
- Play 2** Feet or space? Teammate advantaged - use that for outside-to-inside; didn't occupy between the lines.
- Play 3** Dropping deep to build. Chance to break between the lines or third-man movement - offered

neither.

Play 4 Teammate advantaged wide. Why not use the wide channel?

Key themes

- Early recognition of runners; in behind ball-watching full-back.
- Half-space / between the lines; third-man patterns; wide channels.

Defensive Phase

- Play 1** Aggressive press to block the pass - beaten on the dribble.
- Play 2** Poor counter-press after turnover - beaten on the dribble.
- Play 3** Protect space rather than over-committing on the opponent's body; good effort to stay in the play to the end.
- Play 4** Good counter-press - aggressive block of the passing lane.
- Play 5** Good counter-press - delay and disrupt the opponent's transition.
- Play 6** Good effort - chase and press to force the mistake.

Key themes

- Counter-pressing quality (delay, lane block vs. poor recovery).
- Space protection vs. reckless body pressure; 1v1 after aggressive steps.